Tarbiyyah Global Academy
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EXAMINATIONS AND PRIVATE CANDIDATES POLICY

How International GCSE entries work for an online school

ACADEMIC YEAR 2026 – 2027

Policy name	Examinations and Private Candidates Policy 2026–2027
Applies to	All pupils, parents, staff, trustees and volunteers of Tarbiyyah Global Academy
Policy owner	Examinations Officer
Approved by	Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher
Agreed with	The Chair of Trustees, Tarbiyyah Education Trust
Date of issue	1 September 2026 (version 1.1, updated 28 October 2026 for the January 2027 launch)
Next review due by	31 August 2027
Basis	New policy for online provision (draws on the Tarbiyyah Secondary examination practice and the TGA Fees Policy)
Read alongside	Assessment Policy; Academic Integrity and Secure Assessment Policy; Fees Policy; SEND and Inclusion Policy; Careers Education and Guidance Policy
Availability	Published on the Academy website and Parent Portal. Available in large print or another accessible format on request.

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1. Purpose

Pupils are entered for their examinations through Tarbiyyah Secondary School, which acts as the examination centre; for pupils outside the United Kingdom the Academy helps the family arrange entry at a suitable approved centre near them. This policy explains how the Academy prepares pupils, supports families to secure entries, and manages access arrangements.

2. Responsibilities

Who	Responsibilities
Academy	Teaches the specification; advises on subject and tier choices; provides predicted grades and mock examinations; gives parents a list of suitable centres; supports applications for access arrangements; confirms candidate details to centres on request
Parents	Register and pay the examination centre by its deadlines; ensure the pupil attends with identification; keep the Academy informed of entries and timetables
Examination centre	Accepts the entry, conducts the examination under JCQ regulations, and issues results and certificates
Pupils	Prepare fully, follow the centre's rules, and act with integrity

3. Choosing Qualifications

Pupils are entered for International GCSE examinations, which are assessed by examination and widely available to private candidates in the UK and abroad. Where a course is taught to a GCSE specification, pupils sit the matching International GCSE. If a subject has any non-examined assessment, the Academy will confirm in advance how it can be completed and authenticated.

4. Timeline (typical)

When	What happens
Autumn of Year 10	Academy shares subject, tier and board information and a list of centres
Autumn of Year 11	Mock examinations; Academy issues guidance on entries and tiers
By the centre's deadline (often autumn–January)	Parents secure entries for the summer series
January–March	Access arrangement applications completed with the centre
May–June	Examinations sat at the centre
August	Results issued by the centre; Academy supports post-16 next steps

Late-entry fees charged by awarding bodies or centres are the responsibility of the family.

Founding cohort: pupils who join Year 11 in January 2027 follow a compressed version of this timeline, agreed with each family at admission.

5. Costs

Examination and centre fees are not included in Academy tuition fees and are paid by families directly to the centre, as set out in the Fees Policy. Centre charges vary and are set by the centre.

6. Access Arrangements

Pupils with SEND, medical conditions or temporary injuries may be eligible for access arrangements (for example extra time, a reader or a scribe). The Academy provides evidence of normal way of working and professional reports to support the centre's application under JCQ rules. Families should raise needs as early as possible, ideally by the start of Year 11.

7. Mock Examinations

Mock examinations are held in Year 11 (and at the end of Year 10) under secure conditions, using Safe Exam Browser and live invigilation, or with paper-based submission under timed, camera-on conditions. Results inform predicted grades and entry decisions.

8. Examinations in Other Countries

Families living outside the UK can usually sit International GCSEs at British Council or other approved international centres, which is one reason the Academy enters pupils for International GCSEs. The Academy will advise on centres when subjects are chosen.

9. Subjects and Entry

In Years 10 and 11 pupils follow International GCSE courses in English Language, English Literature, Mathematics, Science (Double Award, or separate Biology, Chemistry and Physics) and Islamic Studies, with options from Arabic, Business, Computer Science and Geography. English Language, Mathematics, Computer Science, Geography and Arabic are taught from the UK GCSE specifications, and teachers add the content and exam practice each International GCSE requires. History is taught from Year 1 to Year 9 and is not offered at Key Stage 4.

International GCSEs are not regulated by Ofqual; the awarding body describes them as generally equivalent to GCSEs, and sixth forms and universities set their own entry requirements. Computer Science includes a 3-hour practical examination on a computer, held in June, so families must choose a centre that can run it. English Language and Arabic have no compulsory speaking test. Geography fieldwork is examined in the written papers, and pupils complete one physical and one human fieldwork enquiry during the course. Entry for Arabic (First Language) is confirmed for each pupil by the end of Year 10.

10. Monitoring and Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the Examinations Officer and Headteacher.

Approved by: Ustadh Abu Zayn Haneef Sandhar, Headteacher · Next review due: 31 August 2027 · Tarbiyyah Global Academy · A specialist education, rooted in faith